

Φιλόχορος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Philochorus of Athens and the Athenian Atthis

eul_aid: lke

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic \(frg\)](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

Philochorus of Athens was a historian and religious expert who lived during the 3rd century BCE, a period of Macedonian rule. A member of a priestly clan associated with the Eleusinian Mysteries, he served Athens as an official interpreter of religious law and omens. According to ancient reports, he was executed around 260 BCE by the Macedonian king Antigonos II Gonatas for his political sympathies toward the rival Ptolemaic dynasty of Egypt.

He was a prolific writer, though none of his works survive intact and are known only through quotations by later authors. His most important work was the **Atthis**, a comprehensive history of Athens and the Attic region in at least seventeen books. He also wrote specialized studies on topics like divination, sacrifices, festivals, and religious mysteries.

Philochorus is considered the last and most significant figure in the tradition of "Atthidography," the writing of local Athenian history. His **Atthis** became the standard authoritative reference on Athenian antiquities, myth, and institutions for later scholars. Modern scholars view the surviving fragments of his work as invaluable evidence for understanding Athenian chronology, political history, and religious practices.

Works (3)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [Atthis: Athenian Origins and Customs](#) · 267 passages
- Ἀπόσπασμα · [On the Sacred War at Delphi](#) · 1 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 8 passages